Verbos modales en inglés

Uso, estructura y ejemplo en contexto QA / entrevistas | Hoja 2 de 6

Reglas generales: Los modales no llevan *-s* en 3ª persona singular · Se usan con el verbo base (sin *to*), excepto *have to / be able to* · No tienen forma de infinitivo ni de participio propio · Para hablar del pasado se combinan con *have + V-pp*

Modal	Uso principal	Estructura	Ejemplo (contexto QA)
can	Habilidad presente, permiso informal	`S + can + V`	*"I can automate this test in Python."*
can't	Imposibilidad, prohibición	`S + can't + V`	*"The test can't run without valid credentials."*
could	Habilidad pasada; posibilidad; permiso formal / sugerencia cortés	`S + could + V`	*"Could you review this PR before the release?"*
could have	Posibilidad que no ocurrió en el pasado	`S + could have + V-pp`	*"We could have caught this bug in code review."*
may	Posibilidad presente o futura; permiso formal	`S + may + V`	*"This bug may affect the production environment."*
might	Posibilidad más remota o incierta	`S + might + V`	*"The test might fail due to a network timeout."*
must	Obligación fuerte (interna); deducción lógica	`S + must + V`	*"You must document every bug before closing the sprint."*
must have	Deducción sobre el pasado	`S + must have + V-pp`	*"The deployment must have failed during the night."*
have to	Obligación externa (las reglas lo exigen)	`S + have/has to + V`	*"We have to deliver the test report by Friday."*
should	Recomendación, consejo, expectativa	`S + should + V`	*"You should add assertions for all edge cases."*
should have	Algo que era conveniente pero no ocurrió (crítica / arrepentimiento)	`S + should have + V-pp`	*"We should have run a smoke test before deploying."*
would	Condicional; cortesía; hábitos pasados (= used to)	`S + would + V`	*"I would start with the highest-priority test cases."*
will	Certeza; decisión espontánea; promesa	`S + will + V`	*"I will have the report ready by end of day."*

Modal + have + V-pp (pasado)

Forma	Significado	Ejemplo
should have done	Era lo correcto pero no se hizo	*"We should have tested it earlier."*
could have done	Era posible pero no ocurrió	*"We could have avoided the hotfix."*
would have done	Habría ocurrido (condicional pasado)	*"I would have caught that bug with better coverage."*
must have done	Deducción sobre el pasado	*"The build must have broken overnight."*

V = Verbo base · V-pp = Participio pasado (3ª forma: done / written / found…) | Hoja 2 de 6